



DESERT BLOOM The vast Atacama Desert in Chile is one of the driest places in the world, with very little rainfall. The bare, baked ground appears bleak and lifeless. When it rains, however, millions of flowering plants, such as these purple pussy-paws, spring up and transform the land into a carpet of color. These short-lived plants, or “ephemerals,” grow from seeds that have long lain dormant in the earth.